

Background.

Let f be analytic on $B_r(z_0) \setminus \{z_0\}$. Then, there is the Laurent's Expansion:

$$f(z) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} a_n \cdot (z-z_0)^n \quad (0 < |z-z_0| < r)$$

where $a_n = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \cdot \int_C \frac{f(z)}{(z-z_0)^{n+1}} dz$ ($n \in \mathbb{Z}$), C is any closed contour around z_0 .

So that $a_{-1} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \cdot \int_C f(z) dz$. Therefore, if we can find the Laurent's expansion, then we can evaluate integral.
 $\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \text{Res}(f; z_0)$

Thm. Suppose that f is analytic inside and on a simple closed contour C , except for isolated singularities at $z_1, \dots, z_n$ inside C . Then

$$\int_C f(z) dz = 2\pi i \sum_{k=1}^n \text{Res}(f, z_k).$$

There are two useful Lemmas.

Lemma. If f has a pole of order m at z_0 , then

$$\text{Res}(f, z_0) = \frac{1}{(m-1)!} \cdot \lim_{z \rightarrow z_0} \left(\frac{d}{dz} \right)^{m-1} (z-z_0)^m f(z).$$

Proof. Observe that $f(z) = \frac{a_{-m}}{(z-z_0)^m} + \dots + \frac{a_{-1}}{z-z_0} + a_0 + a_1(z-z_0) + \dots$ ($a_{-m} \neq 0$)

so that $(z-z_0)^m \cdot f(z) = a_{-m} + a_{-m+1}(z-z_0) + \dots + a_{-1}(z-z_0)^{m-1} + g(z) \cdot (z-z_0)^m$, where g is analytic at z_0 .

Now, differentiating $m-1$ times, and evaluating z_0 . $\square$

Lemma. Let f and g be analytic at z_0 .

If g has a simple zero at z_0 and $f(z_0) \neq 0$, then

$$\text{Res}(f/g, z_0) = \frac{f(z_0)}{g'(z_0)}$$

Proof. Since g has simple zero at z_0 , $1/g$ has a simple pole at z_0 . $\square$

Examples.

$$\int_{|z|=\pi} \frac{e^z - 1}{1 - \cos z} dz = 4\pi i.$$

Since $\cos z = \cos\left(\frac{z}{2} + \frac{z}{2}\right) = \cos^2 \frac{z}{2} - \sin^2 \frac{z}{2} = 1 - 2\sin^2 \frac{z}{2}$, so $\frac{e^z - 1}{1 - \cos z} = \frac{e^z - 1}{2\sin^2(\frac{z}{2})}$ inside $|z| = \pi$,

And, $e^z - 1$ has only one zero at $z = 0$, and $\sin^2(\frac{z}{2}) = 0 \Leftrightarrow z = 2m\pi$ ($m \in \mathbb{Z}$)

so it has only one isolated singularity inside $|z| = \pi$, at $z_0 = 0$.

Moreover, the zero of $e^z - 1$ is order of 1, and $\sin^2(z)$ has order 2,

so the given function has a simple pole at 0. Zero of

$$\text{Now, } \lim_{z \rightarrow 0} z \cdot \frac{e^z - 1}{2\sin^2(\frac{z}{2})} = 2. \text{ Therefore, } \text{Res}(f, 0) = 2.$$

Consequently, the residue theorem gives the result.

$$\int_{|z|=\pi} \frac{\sin z}{1 - \cos z} dz$$

Since $1 - \cos z = 2\sin^2(\frac{z}{2})$ and $\sin z = 2\sin(\frac{z}{2})\cos(\frac{z}{2})$,

$$\frac{\sin z}{1 - \cos z} = \frac{\cos \frac{z}{2}}{\sin \frac{z}{2}}.$$

Example.

Evaluate the integral $\int_0^\infty \frac{\sin x}{x} dx = \frac{\pi}{2}$.

Construct a Curve C as piece-wise: given $\epsilon, R > 0$,

$$C_1: Z_1(t) = \epsilon \cdot e^{-it} \quad (-\pi \leq t \leq 0)$$

$$C_2: Z_2(t) = t \quad (\epsilon \leq t \leq R)$$

$$C_3: Z_3(t) = R \cdot e^{it} \quad (0 \leq t \leq \pi)$$

$$C_4: Z_4(t) = t \quad (-R \leq t \leq -\epsilon)$$

And $C = C_1 \cdot C_2 \cdot C_3 \cdot C_4$. (The composite.)

Now, the function $f(z) = \frac{e^{iz}}{z}$ is analytic inside and on C . So,

$$\int_C f(z) dz = \sum_{i=1}^4 \int_{C_i} f(z) dz$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \int_{-\pi}^{-\epsilon} \frac{e^{it}}{t} dt + \int_{\epsilon}^R \frac{e^{it}}{t} dt + \int_{-\pi}^0 \frac{e^{i\epsilon} \cdot e^{-it}}{\epsilon \cdot e^{-it}} \cdot \epsilon \cdot (-i) \cdot e^{-it} dt + \int_0^{\pi} \frac{e^{iR} \cdot e^{it}}{R \cdot e^{it}} \cdot R \cdot i \cdot e^{it} dt \\ &= \int_{\epsilon}^R \frac{e^{it} - e^{-it}}{t} dt - i \cdot \int_{-\pi}^0 e^{iR} \cdot e^{it} dt + i \cdot \int_0^{\pi} e^{i\epsilon} \cdot e^{-it} dt. \end{aligned}$$

$= 0$ (Cauchy's Theorem).

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Meanwhile, } \left| i \cdot \int_0^{\pi} e^{iR} \cdot e^{it} dt \right| &\leq \int_0^{\pi} |e^{iR} \cdot e^{it}| dt \leq \int_0^{\pi} e^{-R \sin t} dt = 2 \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-R \sin t} dt \\ &\stackrel{0 \leq t \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \Rightarrow \sin t \geq \frac{2t}{\pi}}{\leq} 2 \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-\frac{2Rt}{\pi}} dt = 2 \cdot \left(-\frac{\pi}{2R} \right) \cdot (e^{-R} - 1) \\ &= \frac{1 - e^{-R}}{R} \cdot \pi \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } R \rightarrow \infty. \end{aligned}$$

And, $e^{i\epsilon e^{it}} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n!} (i\epsilon e^{it})^n$ follows $|e^{i\epsilon e^{it}} - 1| \leq \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n!} \cdot \epsilon^n = e^{\epsilon} - 1$, thus

$$\int_{-\pi}^0 e^{i\epsilon e^{it}} dt = \int_{-\pi}^0 e^{i\epsilon e^{it}} - 1 dt + \int_{-\pi}^0 1 dt \rightarrow \pi \text{ as } \epsilon \rightarrow 0.$$

Consequently, letting $R \rightarrow \infty$ and $\epsilon \rightarrow 0$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^\infty \frac{e^{ix} - e^{-ix}}{x} dx &= i\pi. \quad \text{Since } \sin x = (e^{ix} - e^{-ix})/2i, \text{ we obtain} \\ \int_0^\infty \frac{\sin x}{x} dx &= \frac{\pi}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

✓ Evaluate $I = \int_0^{\infty} \frac{x \cdot \sin ax}{x^2 + m^2} dx \quad (a, m > 0).$

Since the function in integral is even, $I = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{x \sin ax}{x^2 + m^2} dx.$

Let C be the contour, Composite $t \rightarrow t$ ($-R \leq t \leq R$) and $t \rightarrow R e^{it}$ ($0 \leq t \leq \pi$).
Then C is a closed simple curve. Meanwhile, the function

$$f(z) = \frac{z e^{iaz}}{z^2 + m^2}$$

The $z^2 + m^2 = (z + im)(z - im)$ has only one zero in the upper half-plane, im ,
so f has only one simple pole inside C , for $R > m$. Moreover,

$$\text{Res}(f, im) = \lim_{z \rightarrow im} (z - im) \cdot \frac{z e^{iaz}}{z^2 + m^2} = \frac{im \cdot e^{-am}}{2im} = \frac{1}{2} \cdot e^{-am}.$$

By the Residue Theorem, for Γ_R , the semicircular part of C ,

$$\int_C f dz = \int_{-R}^R f(x) dx + \int_{\Gamma_R} f(z) dz = \pi i \cdot e^{-am} \quad \dots (*)$$

And since

$$\begin{aligned} \left| \int_{\Gamma_R} f(z) dz \right| &= \left| \int_0^{\pi} \frac{R e^{it} \cdot e^{ia \cdot R e^{it}}}{R^2 \cdot e^{2it} + m^2} R i e^{it} dt \right| & R^2 + m^2 \geq R^2 - m^2 \\ &\leq \frac{R^2}{R^2 - m^2} \cdot \int_0^{\pi} e^{-aR \cdot \sin t} dt \\ &= \frac{R^2}{R^2 - m^2} \cdot 2 \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-aR \sin t} dt & \frac{2}{\pi} t \leq \sin t, \text{ in } 0 \leq t \leq \frac{\pi}{2}. \\ &\leq \frac{2R^2}{R^2 - m^2} \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-aR \cdot \frac{2}{\pi} t} dt \\ &= \frac{2R^2}{R^2 - m^2} \cdot \frac{\pi}{-2aR} \cdot (e^{-aR} - 1) \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } R \rightarrow \infty. \end{aligned}$$

So, letting $R \rightarrow \infty$ in $(*)$, we obtain

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{x}{x^2 + m^2} (\cos ax + i \sin ax) = \pi e^{-am} i.$$

Compare the imaginary part, we obtain that

$$I = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \pi \cdot e^{-am}.$$

1. Evaluate

$$\int_0^{\infty} \sin x^2 dx = \int_0^{\infty} \cos x^2 dx = \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2\sqrt{2}}.$$

Let C be a curve, composite of

$$C_1 \text{ with } t (0 \leq t \leq R), \quad C_2 \text{ with } Re^{it} (0 \leq t \leq \frac{\pi}{4}), \quad C_3 \text{ with } -t \cdot e^{\frac{it}{2}} (-R \leq t \leq 0)$$

Since e^{iz^2} is entire, being composition of entire, we can apply the Cauchy's Theorem

$$0 = \int_C e^{iz^2} dz = \int_0^R e^{it^2} dt + \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{4}} e^{i(Re^{it})^2} \cdot Re^{it} dt + \int_{-R}^0 e^{i(-t)^2 \cdot e^{i\frac{\pi}{2}}} \cdot e^{\frac{it}{2}} dt$$

Since $e^{iz^2} = i$,

$$\int_0^R e^{it^2} dt + \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{4}} e^{i(R^2 e^{2it})} \cdot Re^{it} dt = \int_{-R}^0 e^{-t^2} dt \cdot e^{\frac{it}{2}} = e^{\frac{it}{2}} \cdot \int_0^R e^{-t^2} dt.$$

Meanwhile, observe that

$$\begin{aligned} \left| \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{4}} e^{iR^2 e^{2it}} \cdot Re^{it} dt \right| &\leq R \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{4}} |e^{iR^2 e^{2it}}| dt \\ &= R \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{4}} e^{-R^2 \sin 2t} dt \\ &= \frac{R}{2} \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-R^2 \sin t} dt \\ &\leq \frac{R}{2} \cdot \int_0^{\frac{\pi}{2}} e^{-R^2 \cdot \frac{2t}{\pi}} dt \\ &= \frac{R\pi}{2R^2} (1 - e^{-R^2}) \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } R \rightarrow \infty. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, letting $R \rightarrow \infty$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^{\infty} e^{ix^2} dx &= e^{\frac{it}{2}} \cdot \int_0^{\infty} e^{-x^2} dx = \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + i \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \right) \cdot \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2} \\ &= \int_0^{\infty} \cos x^2 dx + i \cdot \int_0^{\infty} \sin x^2 dx \end{aligned}$$

So, Comparing the imaginary part, we obtain that

$$\int_0^{\infty} \sin x^2 dx = \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2\sqrt{2}}.$$

